

TOPIC 5: SPEECH WRITING

A speech is a written material meant to be presented orally to a target audience.

Speeches are meant to inform, entertain, persuade, educate or motivate people to action.

Kinds of speeches

A. For entertainment e.g

Birthday party

Weddings

Dinner party etc.

B. For information/to educate the audience e.g

Paper presentation to impart knowledge

Farewell speech.

C. For persuasion

Speech that its aim is to convince the audience on a particular issue

D. For condolences

FEATURES OF A SPEECH

1. **The title:** The title of a speech should contain the following; the purpose, name and title of the speaker, occasion, place, date and time e.g. A farewell speech presented by Martin Owo, the head boy of Government Secondary School Kubwa on the send forth ceremony of our dearly beloved principal, Mr Idris Kunle, at the assembly hall, on 20th April, 2024 at 10am

2. Introduction

This must be carefully done to attract the attention of the audience by recognizing the special guest/audience present. It must start with salutation.

Example

The chairman of the occasion, the principal, the management staff, the PTA Ladies and gentlemen. I feel highly honored to stand here today to deliver my speech on

3. The Body

This contains the main message. Start by giving your main points and then support each point with relevant details, comparisons and contrasts etc. explaining who, when, where, why, how. All should be presented in good English.

4. The Conclusion

Here you summarize your main points. It is important to end in a memorable way by

- i. making a forceful and shocking statement
- ii. provide some further food for thought
- iii. leaving your audience with positive memories of your speech

Guidelines

1. A speech is meant to be delivered to an audience, hence, the use of present tense is required.
2. It should be in four sections; headings, introduction, body and conclusion.
3. Slangs and humour should be avoided unless it is for informal situation
4. No name at the end of the speech.

Assignment

Prepare a speech to be delivered on the prize and award giving day of the final year students of the school.